Fading, by degrees.

Twelve specimens, from a few letters to a flowing story. Each numbered frame is editable.
The settings below were applied by Tracking Ramp itself; the changing text is the demonstration.

01 A widening sentence

Tracking / Word / Linear / 0 to 180
Letters and spaces / Auto steps / Entire story

Light had been working quietly. Each morning it crossed the room, touched the same objects, and took a little color with it. Blue softened into grey. A photograph grew pale at its edges, while the face at its center remained almost familiar.

Long text: one continuous ramp across all words.

02 A stepped disappearance

Tracking / Word / Ease out / 0 to 260
4 steps / Letters and spaces / Entire story

Some things fade
between the words
we leave behind.

Each word and its following gap share one tracking value.

03 A bell in every line

Tracking / Word / Gaussian / 0 to 260
Restart: Line / Justified / Breaks: on / Metrics: on

The room keeps a softer record of us. Curtains
0 45 126 218 260 218 126 45 0
lose their blue. Paper turns warm at the edges.
0 45 126 218 260 218 126 45 0
Every line begins again, opening at its center
0 57 163 260 260 163 57 0
and returning to quiet before the next breath.
0 57 163 260 260 163 57 0

5 pt numbers print in the gap below each text row.

04 Small, large, small

Font size / Character / Gaussian / 14 to 48 pt
Restart: Word / Letters and spaces / Auto steps

fading
fading
fading

The complete size curve starts again inside each word.

05 A rising memory

Baseline shift / Character / Sine / 0 to 14 pt
Restart: Never / Letters and spaces / Auto steps

What stays
when light
leaves?

The glyphs rise and fall. Leading stays at 48 pt.

06 Color, then begin again

Character color / Word / Linear / Ink to Ink 30%
Restart: Paragraph / Letters and spaces / Auto steps

A letter fades from black to a quiet trace. Its message remains, even as the ink grows light.

The second memory begins in darkness, then follows the first toward the edge of sight.

Same-base tints fade without generating new swatches.

07 A sentence stretches

Horizontal scale / Word / Linear / 65 to 145%
Restart: Sentence / Letters and spaces / Auto steps

The edges grow quiet.

The hours spread thin.

The colors drift away.

Three sentences; three independent distributions.

08 Keep, then add

Skew -20 to 20 degrees; tracking 0 to 110
Use + Add property to keep skew, then add tracking.
Lower sample: rotation -12 to 12 degrees / Sine

leaning memory

letters drift away

Two stacked properties above; separate rotation below.

09 Weight and outline

Variable weight: 800 to 100 / Word / Linear
Stroke width: 0 to 1 pt / Character / Linear

Light loses weight.

almost gone

Axis: Weight. The lower sample has a white fill.

10 A shaped measure

Line width: 58 to 100% / Centered / Smooth
Independent Gaussian contour; text tracking: 0

A room can fade without becoming empty. Light still reaches the table. A cup still marks its small circle on the wood. Only the boundaries change: the space narrows, opens, and narrows again, holding a different measure of the same familiar words. We keep reading until the edges close around the last quiet trace of a place we thought would always stay.

A longer passage flows through a changing frame width.

11 What fits the frame

Current frame / Character / Linear / 0 to 100
Same longer text; left: original / right: applied

ORIGINAL

Light leaves slowly. It crosses the room every morning, taking a little color from the curtains and a little certainty from the photograph. The objects remain in place. Their edges become less exact, until memory supplies the details

APPLIED

Light leaves slowly. It crosses the room every morning, taking a little color from the curtains and a little certainty from the photograph. The objects remain in place. Their edges become less exact,

Text leaving the right frame returns to its baseline.

12 One linked story

Tracking / Frame / Linear / 0 to 140
Entire story / Letters and spaces / Two linked frames

FRAME 1 / 0

Fading is not always a departure. Sometimes it is a change in how a thing remains. The photograph stays on the shelf, the path stays through the grass, and the voice stays somewhere in the room. What disappears is the sharp border

FRAME 2 / 140

between presence and memory. We learn the shape again through its softer edges.

The curve assigns one value to each visible frame.

OPEN & EXPLORE

Open the INDD or IDML. In Layers, select a numbered frame on the Editable specimens layer. Run Tracking Ramp.jsx.

ADD ANOTHER PROPERTY

Set an effect, click + Add property, then choose the next property. Apply all keeps the stack; Cancel restores the starting state.

READ THE RESULTS

Allow added line breaks is off by default. Auto-stabilize can use Fixed sampling without changing paragraph structure.

A line can change.

Weight and offset follow characters or words. Indents move complete paragraphs.
Each example keeps its saved baseline, so you can replace the curve and explore.

13 Underline weight

Character or Word / Auto steps / 0.2 to 6 pt / Letters and spaces
The text stays the same size while the underline grows or forms a bell.

CHARACTER / LINEAR

the ink grows quiet

WORD / GAUSSIAN

one line holds a memory

Underlining switches on automatically. Existing underline color, style and offset are retained.

14 Underline offset

Character: Sine / Word: Linear / -2 to 12 pt / Underline weight held at 1 pt
Negative offsets move above the baseline; positive offsets move below it.

CHARACTER / SINE

the line drifts below the letters

WORD / LINEAR

the words hold another horizon

15 Paragraph indents

Paragraph / Linear / Four steps per sample / One value for each complete paragraph
Left and right: 0 to 72 pt. First line: -18 to 36 pt, with a fixed 18 pt left indent.

LEFT INDENT / 0 TO 72 PT

Light reaches the table. A little color leaves the room.

Memory keeps the edges. A familiar shape becomes less exact.

The page grows quieter. We read what remains between words.

Nothing leaves at once. The last trace takes its time.

RIGHT INDENT / 0 TO 72 PT

Light reaches the table. A little color leaves the room.

Memory keeps the edges. A familiar shape becomes less exact.

The page grows quieter. We read what remains between words.

Nothing leaves at once. The last trace takes its time.

FIRST LINE / -18 TO 36 PT

Light reaches the table. A little color leaves the room.

Memory keeps the edges. A familiar shape becomes less exact.

The page grows quieter. We read what remains between words.

Nothing leaves at once. The last trace takes its time.

WHOLE PARAGRAPHS

A partial selection includes each paragraph it touches. Indents can also affect a continuation in another frame or overset.

REPLACE & RESTORE

Cancel restores the starting formatting. Reapplying restores old targets before assigning new values. Underline automatic values are preserved.

ONE CURVE PER SCOPE

Indent properties use Paragraph, Both and Never restart. Curves run across the selected paragraphs without splitting their formatting.

A changing measure.

Allow added line breaks chooses the compromise: per-line indents, or a frame contour.
Turn it off to preserve paragraphs. Turn it on for managed, independently fitted rows.

16 A longer bell

Line length / Gaussian / 45 to 100% / Auto steps / Added line breaks: ON
Each fitted row is a paragraph with equal left and right indents.

The light fades slowly enough that we almost miss the change. A curtain gives up its blue, a table loses the hard edge of its shadow, and the afternoon makes a softer shape around the room. Nothing has gone, yet everything has moved a little further into memory. We read the same words again and find more space around them. The measure opens toward the middle, holding a longer breath, then draws inward as the passage reaches its end.

A photograph remains beside the window. Its colors have grown quiet, but the face is still there. Fading can be a way of staying: less exact, less certain, and still recognizable. What remains asks us to look more slowly, until the last lines gather around a small and familiar trace.

17 A shorter ramp

Line length / Linear / 40 to 100% / Auto steps / Added line breaks: OFF
A centered contour follows frame height. The paragraph stays intact.

A trace remains. The color leaves first, then the sharp edges of the room. What stays is a rhythm: a few words held close, a longer sentence opening into light, and the quiet after it.

TRY A DIFFERENT CURVE

Select specimen 16 or 17. Choose Line length - centered. Compare Allow added line breaks on and off, then change the curve or steps.

REPLACE & RESTORE

Replace restores owned gaps or the original frame before applying the new mode. Cancel restores everything. Apply keeps one Undo action.

ONE RECTANGULAR FRAME

Both modes need one unthreaded rectangular frame. With added breaks, paragraph-aware styles may repeat on the new rows.

Between two styles.

Choose Style A and Style B. One curve blends their shared numeric settings and compatible colors.
Font families and on/off settings stay unchanged; the source character styles remain editable.

18 One curve, several settings

Character-style blend / Word / Linear / 0 to 100% / Auto steps
A: 14 pt, tracking 0, shift 0, Ink. B: 30 pt, tracking 160, shift 6, Mist.

A memory fades through several changes at once. The letters grow, the spaces open, and the ink gives way to a softer grey. The words remain themselves, even as their presence changes. We can follow the whole passage from a small, dark beginning toward a larger and quieter end, or bend the curve and bring its strongest moment back into the center. Nothing is altered in the source styles. The page holds the steps between them.

19 A blend inside every word

Character / Restart: Word / Gaussian / 0 to 100% / Letters and spaces
A: 32 pt, tracking 0, Ink. B: 72 pt, tracking 160, Mist.
Blend attributes: Font size, Tracking and Character color. Baseline shift is excluded.

fading slowly

leaving soft ly

20 Variable-font endpoints

Word / Linear inverted / B to A / Same variable-font file
A: 24 pt, Weight 100. B: 40 pt, Weight 800. Size and axes blend together.

Light loses its weight.

EDIT THE ENDPOINTS

Edit styles in Character Styles > Guide blends, then Reapply. Graph: Average summarizes groups; Group inspects one word.

CHOOSE ATTRIBUTES

Shared supported attributes are automatic. Blend attributes lets you exclude them and lists missing or unsupported values.

KEEP & RESTORE

Add another property to keep the blend. Cancel restores the starting state. Apply all commits the stack as one Undo action.

Keep the instructions.

A missing endpoint can come from the original text. A saved setup remembers the full sequence.
Reopen an editable specimen: its controls load without changing the document. Preview when ready.

21 An outline from nothing

Word / Linear / 0 to 100% / Missing values: Original text
A leaves skew and stroke unspecified. B defines skew 24 degrees, stroke 2 pt and Ink.

A *trace remains.*

22 The original text is the starting point

Word / Linear / 0 to 100% / Original text endpoints
Original sizes: 24 pt, then 18 pt. B defines 30 pt and skew 18 degrees. Both-missing settings stay unchanged.

The first words have already changed before the curve begins. They are a *little larger*, holding their shape *against the light. The rest of the passage starts quietly. As each word approaches the second style, its size and angle move toward the same destination. A missing setting is taken from the text that was there at the beginning. The page remembers that starting point, so another preview does not keep adding the previous change.*

23 Reopen the whole sequence

Kept Character-style blend, then Tracking / Word / Linear
Blend: A to B, 0 to 100%. Tracking: 0 to 80. Both stages are saved with this frame.

A remembered curve can return to the page. Close the dialog, change a source character style, and open this frame again. Its saved setup loads with preview off. Reapply reads the new endpoint values and calculates the whole sequence from its original baseline. The words can change without losing the instructions that brought them here.

OPEN AGAIN

Select the same frame and run the script. Saved setup loaded identifies its settings. Preview and Reapply update the document explicitly.

REAPPLY FROM THE START

The full stack restores its previous baseline first. Source styles are reread; previews do not accumulate earlier values. Cancel restores the committed appearance.

FORGET, KEEP THE APPEARANCE

Forget saved setup adopts the current formatting, breaks and shape. It stops recall, leaves the appearance in place, and has its own Undo step.